

GOVERNMENT: IS IT A HINDRANCE OR FACILITATOR OF CHANGE?

“Changes have come from decisive leadership”

PRANAB MUKHERJEE UNION MINISTER FOR EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

The theme of the 2009 India Today Conclave, ‘Challenges of Change’, has been wisely chosen. To me, change is a multidimensional concept. Some aspects of change can be measured by indices like growth rate, per capita income, human development index, and others which relate to the ethos and psyche of a nation. Yet, for the growth of a nation, change is essential.

As a person who has spent a better part of his life in public service and in the government, I would like to believe that the government is, more often, a facilitator and, at times, a regulator of change. Indeed it should be so in any democratic society.

The three main factors that make a government a facilitator of change are: leadership, vision and expertise. History tells us that all momentous changes in the world have come from the exercise of decisive leadership. These have also been individuals who have either seized the opportunity to usher in change or have enjoyed a broad-based mandate to undertake change. I would identify the role played by Rajiv Gandhi who enjoyed a massive mandate to prepare the country for the 21st century. His leadership and vision helped India emerge as an IT powerhouse within a decade or so.

“INDIA’S OWN EXPERIENCE AS A MODERN NATION

DEMONSTRATES THAT THE GOVERNMENT HAS PLAYED A CRITICAL AND PIVOTAL ROLE IN THE MANAGEMENT OF CHANGE.”

PRANAB MUKHERJEE

RAVIV SAHANI